

metrics

➤ **\$44 million**

was spent on streaming media enabled advertising in 2000.

Worldwide revenues from e-recruiting in 2000 was

➤ **\$1.6 billion**

Source: www.idg.net

R.I.P. the Power Mac G4 cube

All you Mac fans, there's sad news coming your way. Apple is discontinuing production of the Power Mac G4 cube due to lack of demand. The 8-inch cube, which was launched last July, is almost one-fourth the size of the Power Mac G4.

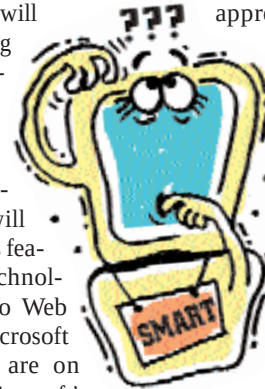
Apple says that the sales of G4 cube were not enough to justify sustaining it. In fact, the sales were far lower than

what the company had expected. Most customers go in for the more powerful Power Mac G4 mini towers than the G4 cube.

Of course, you can continue to hope that the G4 cube will be back in a new upgraded avatar. But as of now, Apple doesn't have any plans to do so in the near future.

XP Smart tag—not so smart!

Microsoft has announced that Windows XP will not be carrying Smart Tag technology—a result of the negative public reaction to this feature. However, Office XP will still be having this feature. Smart Tag technology links users to Web sites chosen by Microsoft even when they are on sites other than Microsoft's.



This has caused widespread apprehension that sites other than those favoured by Microsoft will be neglected. Online browsing could become very Microsoft-centric if this is incorporated into the operating system. Trust good old Bill to have a finger in every pie!

Online funerals?

What's the world's coming to? Now they've decided to put live broadcasting of funerals online as well.

EulogyCast, a company in the US has announced its live, private broadcasting services of funerals and memorials.

Shameful is not enough to describe it!

Who is?

Ximian Mono

▲ *What is it?*

This is an initiative from the open source community to compete against Microsoft's .Net since Microsoft's position in the Internet area is as yet not considerable. .Net has several advanced features such as ASP.Net, that won't be available to ordinary developers on other platforms. Therefore, only Windows OS users can get the best experience, obviously something that the open source community doesn't want to happen!

Mono provides developers with a platform with which they can develop .Net compatible applications. These .Net applications can run on Windows or Mono supported platforms such as Linux and Unix.

▲ *Who is developing it?*

Ximian, who made the Gnome interface for Linux and Unix is behind Mono. Check out www.ximian.com.

▲ *When is it coming out?*

The tools and libraries of Mono are expected to be out by the first half of 2002.

tomorrow technology

Small is efficient

The question of how to connect molecular sized computers has been resolved by researchers from Hewlett-Packard. The solution, though conceptual, lies in making use of a kind of atomic pixie dust. Phil Kuekes and Stan Williams, both working at HP labs were awarded a US patent for the concept which involves throwing atomic dust, based on gold and other molecules, between the ends of nanowires and wires. Also included is a testing process that provides identities to the connections, making it easy to control them.

The group had already fig-

ured out ways to build molecular chips to store information and crunch data. Their next target, by 2005, is a 16 kilobit molecular memory chip that



would hold 16,000 pieces of binary yes-or-no data. A small amount, but still large enough to make hooking up the molecular chip to the computer wires, a royal pain.

"Nanowires" are crystals of six to 10 atoms wide and two atoms tall and are essentially what the molecular chips are made of. Growing the crystals in parallel and laying them one above the other creates a grid. When energy is passed through the grid, a molecule that could be present in each intersection of nanowires moves, thereby making it an on-off binary switch required for computer memory and computation.

The biggest challenge lies in connecting these nanowires or crystals to the 100 times bigger wires comprising today's computers.